THE FIRST EPISTLE OF PAUL
TO THE CORINTHIANS

1 CORINTHIANS

1 Paul, called by the will of God to be an apostle of Christ
Jesus, and our brother Sosthenes,

[2]To the church of God that is in Corinth, to those sanctified in Christ Jesus, called to be saints together with all those who in every place call upon the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, both their Lord and ours:

[3]Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

[4]I give thanks to my God always for you because of the grace of God that was given you in Christ Jesus, [5]that in every way you were enriched in him in all speech and all knowledge—[6]even as the testimony about Christ was confirmed among you—[7]so that you are not lacking in any gift, as you wait for the revealing of our Lord Jesus Christ, [8]who will sustain you to the end, guiltless in the day of our Lord Jesus Christ. [9]God is faithful, by whom you were called into the fellowship of his Son, Jesus Christ our Lord.

[10]I appeal to you, brothers, by the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that all of you agree, and that there be no divisions among you, but that you be united in the same mind and the same judgment. [11]For it has been reported to me by Chloe's people that there is quarreling among you, my brothers. [12]What I mean is that each one of you says, "I follow Paul," or "I follow Apollos," or "I follow Cephas," or "I follow Christ."

[13] Is Christ divided? Was Paul crucified for you? Or were you
baptized in the name of Paul? [14] I thank God that I baptized
none of you except Crispus and Gaius, [15] so that no one may say
that you were baptized in my name. [16] (I did baptize also the
household of Stephanas. Beyond that, I do not know whether
I baptized anyone else.) [17] For Christ did not send me to bap-
tize but to preach the gospel, and not with words of eloquent
wisdom, lest the cross of Christ be emptied of its power.

[18] For the word of the cross is folly to those who are perish-
ing, but to us who are being saved it is the power of God. [19] For
it is written,

> "I will destroy the wisdom of the wise,
> and the discernment of the discerning I will
> thwart."

[20] Where is the one who is wise? Where is the scribe? Where is
the debater of this age? Has not God made foolish the wisdom
of the world? [21] For since, in the wisdom of God, the world did
not know God through wisdom, it pleased God through the
folly of what we preach to save those who believe. [22] For Jews
demand signs and Greeks seek wisdom, [23] but we preach Christ
crucified, a stumbling block to Jews and folly to Gentiles,
[24] but to those who are called, both Jews and Greeks, Christ the
power of God and the wisdom of God. [25] For the foolishness of
God is wiser than men, and the weakness of God is stronger
than men.

[26] For consider your calling, brothers: not many of you were
wise according to worldly standards, not many were powerful,

not many were of noble birth. [27] But God chose what is foolish
in the world to shame the wise; God chose what is weak in
the world to shame the strong; [28] God chose what is low and
despised in the world, even things that are not, to bring to
nothing things that are, [29] so that no human being might boast
in the presence of God. [30] And because of him you are in Christ
Jesus, who became to us wisdom from God, righteousness and
sanctification and redemption, [31] so that, as it is written, "Let
the one who boasts, boast in the Lord."

2 And I, when I came to you, brothers, did not come pro-
claiming to you the testimony of God with lofty speech or
wisdom. [2] For I decided to know nothing among you except
Jesus Christ and him crucified. [3] And I was with you in weak-
ness and in fear and much trembling, [4] and my speech and
my message were not in plausible words of wisdom, but in
demonstration of the Spirit and of power, [5] so that your faith
might not rest in the wisdom of men but in the power of God.

[6] Yet among the mature we do impart wisdom, although it
is not a wisdom of this age or of the rulers of this age, who are
doomed to pass away. [7] But we impart a secret and hidden wis-
dom of God, which God decreed before the ages for our glory.
[8] None of the rulers of this age understood this, for if they had,
they would not have crucified the Lord of glory. [9] But, as it is
written,

> "What no eye has seen, nor ear heard,
> nor the heart of man imagined,
> what God has prepared for those who love him"—

[10] these things God has revealed to us through the Spirit. For
the Spirit searches everything, even the depths of God. [11] For
who knows a person's thoughts except the spirit of that
person, which is in him? So also no one comprehends the
thoughts of God except the Spirit of God. [12] Now we have
received not the spirit of the world, but the Spirit who is from
God, that we might understand the things freely given us by
God. [13] And we impart this in words not taught by human wis-
dom but taught by the Spirit, interpreting spiritual truths to
those who are spiritual.

[14] The natural person does not accept the things of the
Spirit of God, for they are folly to him, and he is not able to
understand them because they are spiritually discerned. [15] The
spiritual person judges all things, but is himself to be judged
by no one. [16] "For who has understood the mind of the Lord so
as to instruct him?" But we have the mind of Christ.

3 But I, brothers, could not address you as spiritual people,
but as people of the flesh, as infants in Christ. [2] I fed you with
milk, not solid food, for you were not ready for it. And even
now you are not yet ready, [3] for you are still of the flesh. For
while there is jealousy and strife among you, are you not of
the flesh and behaving only in a human way? [4] For when one
says, "I follow Paul," and another, "I follow Apollos," are you
not being merely human?

[5] What then is Apollos? What is Paul? Servants through
whom you believed, as the Lord assigned to each. [6] I planted,
Apollos watered, but God gave the growth. [7] So neither he who
plants nor he who waters is anything, but only God who gives

the growth. [8] He who plants and he who waters are one, and
each will receive his wages according to his labor. [9] For we are
God's fellow workers. You are God's field, God's building.

[10] According to the grace of God given to me, like a skilled
master builder I laid a foundation, and someone else is build-
ing upon it. Let each one take care how he builds upon it. [11] For
no one can lay a foundation other than that which is laid,
which is Jesus Christ. [12] Now if anyone builds on the foun-
dation with gold, silver, precious stones, wood, hay, straw—
[13] each one's work will become manifest, for the Day will
disclose it, because it will be revealed by fire, and the fire will
test what sort of work each one has done. [14] If the work that
anyone has built on the foundation survives, he will receive
a reward. [15] If anyone's work is burned up, he will suffer loss,
though he himself will be saved, but only as through fire.

[16] Do you not know that you are God's temple and that
God's Spirit dwells in you? [17] If anyone destroys God's temple,
God will destroy him. For God's temple is holy, and you are
that temple.

[18] Let no one deceive himself. If anyone among you thinks
that he is wise in this age, let him become a fool that he may
become wise. [19] For the wisdom of this world is folly with God.
For it is written, "He catches the wise in their craftiness,"
[20] and again, "The Lord knows the thoughts of the wise, that
they are futile." [21] So let no one boast in men. For all things are
yours, [22] whether Paul or Apollos or Cephas or the world or life
or death or the present or the future—all are yours, [23] and you
are Christ's, and Christ is God's.

4 This is how one should regard us, as servants of Christ and
stewards of the mysteries of God. [2]Moreover, it is required of
stewards that they be found faithful. [3]But with me it is a very
small thing that I should be judged by you or by any human
court. In fact, I do not even judge myself. [4]For I am not aware
of anything against myself, but I am not thereby acquitted.
It is the Lord who judges me. [5]Therefore do not pronounce
judgment before the time, before the Lord comes, who will
bring to light the things now hidden in darkness and will dis-
close the purposes of the heart. Then each one will receive his
commendation from God.

[6]I have applied all these things to myself and Apollos for
your benefit, brothers, that you may learn by us not to go
beyond what is written, that none of you may be puffed up in
favor of one against another. [7]For who sees anything different
in you? What do you have that you did not receive? If then you
received it, why do you boast as if you did not receive it?

[8]Already you have all you want! Already you have become
rich! Without us you have become kings! And would that
you did reign, so that we might share the rule with you! [9]For
I think that God has exhibited us apostles as last of all, like
men sentenced to death, because we have become a spectacle
to the world, to angels, and to men. [10]We are fools for Christ's
sake, but you are wise in Christ. We are weak, but you are
strong. You are held in honor, but we in disrepute. [11]To the
present hour we hunger and thirst, we are poorly dressed and
buffeted and homeless, [12]and we labor, working with our own
hands. When reviled, we bless; when persecuted, we endure;

[13]when slandered, we entreat. We have become, and are still,
like the scum of the world, the refuse of all things.

[14]I do not write these things to make you ashamed, but to
admonish you as my beloved children. [15]For though you have
countless guides in Christ, you do not have many fathers.
For I became your father in Christ Jesus through the gospel.
[16]I urge you, then, be imitators of me. [17]That is why I sent you
Timothy, my beloved and faithful child in the Lord, to remind
you of my ways in Christ, as I teach them everywhere in every
church. [18]Some are arrogant, as though I were not coming
to you. [19]But I will come to you soon, if the Lord wills, and I
will find out not the talk of these arrogant people but their
power. [20]For the kingdom of God does not consist in talk but
in power. [21]What do you wish? Shall I come to you with a rod,
or with love in a spirit of gentleness?

5 It is actually reported that there is sexual immorality
among you, and of a kind that is not tolerated even among
pagans, for a man has his father's wife. [2]And you are arrogant!
Ought you not rather to mourn? Let him who has done this
be removed from among you.

[3]For though absent in body, I am present in spirit; and as if
present, I have already pronounced judgment on the one who
did such a thing. [4]When you are assembled in the name of the
Lord Jesus and my spirit is present, with the power of our Lord
Jesus, [5]you are to deliver this man to Satan for the destruction of
the flesh, so that his spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord.

[6]Your boasting is not good. Do you not know that a little
leaven leavens the whole lump? [7]Cleanse out the old leaven

that you may be a new lump, as you really are unleavened. For
Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed. [8]Let us there-
fore celebrate the festival, not with the old leaven, the leaven
of malice and evil, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity
and truth.

[9]I wrote to you in my letter not to associate with sexually
immoral people—[10]not at all meaning the sexually immoral
of this world, or the greedy and swindlers, or idolaters, since
then you would need to go out of the world. [11]But now I am
writing to you not to associate with anyone who bears the
name of brother if he is guilty of sexual immorality or greed,
or is an idolater, reviler, drunkard, or swindler—not even
to eat with such a one. [12]For what have I to do with judging
outsiders? Is it not those inside the church whom you are
to judge? [13]God judges those outside. "Purge the evil person
from among you."

6 When one of you has a grievance against another, does he
dare go to law before the unrighteous instead of the saints?
[2]Or do you not know that the saints will judge the world? And
if the world is to be judged by you, are you incompetent to try
trivial cases? [3]Do you not know that we are to judge angels?
How much more, then, matters pertaining to this life! [4]So if
you have such cases, why do you lay them before those who
have no standing in the church? [5]I say this to your shame. Can
it be that there is no one among you wise enough to settle a
dispute between the brothers, [6]but brother goes to law against
brother, and that before unbelievers? [7]To have lawsuits at all
with one another is already a defeat for you. Why not rather

suffer wrong? Why not rather be defrauded? [8]But you your-
selves wrong and defraud—even your own brothers!

[9]Or do you not know that the unrighteous will not inherit
the kingdom of God? Do not be deceived: neither the sexually
immoral, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor men who practice
homosexuality, [10]nor thieves, nor the greedy, nor drunkards,
nor revilers, nor swindlers will inherit the kingdom of God.
[11]And such were some of you. But you were washed, you were
sanctified, you were justified in the name of the Lord Jesus
Christ and by the Spirit of our God.

[12]"All things are lawful for me," but not all things are help-
ful. "All things are lawful for me," but I will not be dominated
by anything. [13]"Food is meant for the stomach and the stom-
ach for food"—and God will destroy both one and the other.
The body is not meant for sexual immorality, but for the Lord,
and the Lord for the body. [14]And God raised the Lord and will
also raise us up by his power. [15]Do you not know that your
bodies are members of Christ? Shall I then take the members
of Christ and make them members of a prostitute? Never!
[16]Or do you not know that he who is joined to a prostitute
becomes one body with her? For, as it is written, "The two will
become one flesh." [17]But he who is joined to the Lord becomes
one spirit with him. [18]Flee from sexual immorality. Every
other sin a person commits is outside the body, but the sex-
ually immoral person sins against his own body. [19]Or do you
not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit within
you, whom you have from God? You are not your own, [20]for
you were bought with a price. So glorify God in your body.

7 Now concerning the matters about which you wrote: "It
is good for a man not to have sexual relations with a woman."
[2]But because of the temptation to sexual immorality, each
man should have his own wife and each woman her own
husband. [3]The husband should give to his wife her conjugal
rights, and likewise the wife to her husband. [4]For the wife
does not have authority over her own body, but the husband
does. Likewise the husband does not have authority over his
own body, but the wife does. [5]Do not deprive one another,
except perhaps by agreement for a limited time, that you
may devote yourselves to prayer; but then come together
again, so that Satan may not tempt you because of your lack
of self-control.

[6]Now as a concession, not a command, I say this. [7]I wish
that all were as I myself am. But each has his own gift from
God, one of one kind and one of another.

[8]To the unmarried and the widows I say that it is good for
them to remain single, as I am. [9]But if they cannot exercise
self-control, they should marry. For it is better to marry than
to burn with passion.

[10]To the married I give this charge (not I, but the Lord): the
wife should not separate from her husband [11](but if she does,
she should remain unmarried or else be reconciled to her hus-
band), and the husband should not divorce his wife.

[12]To the rest I say (I, not the Lord) that if any brother has a
wife who is an unbeliever, and she consents to live with him,
he should not divorce her. [13]If any woman has a husband who
is an unbeliever, and he consents to live with her, she should

not divorce him. [14]For the unbelieving husband is made holy
because of his wife, and the unbelieving wife is made holy
because of her husband. Otherwise your children would be
unclean, but as it is, they are holy. [15]But if the unbelieving
partner separates, let it be so. In such cases the brother or sis-
ter is not enslaved. God has called you to peace. [16]For how do
you know, wife, whether you will save your husband? Or how
do you know, husband, whether you will save your wife?

[17]Only let each person lead the life that the Lord has
assigned to him, and to which God has called him. This is my
rule in all the churches. [18]Was anyone at the time of his call
already circumcised? Let him not seek to remove the marks
of circumcision. Was anyone at the time of his call uncircum-
cised? Let him not seek circumcision. [19]For neither circum-
cision counts for anything nor uncircumcision, but keeping
the commandments of God. [20]Each one should remain in the
condition in which he was called. [21]Were you a bondservant
when called? Do not be concerned about it. (But if you can
gain your freedom, avail yourself of the opportunity.) [22]For he
who was called in the Lord as a bondservant is a freedman of
the Lord. Likewise he who was free when called is a bondser-
vant of Christ. [23]You were bought with a price; do not become
bondservants of men. [24]So, brothers, in whatever condition
each was called, there let him remain with God.

[25]Now concerning the betrothed, I have no command
from the Lord, but I give my judgment as one who by the
Lord's mercy is trustworthy. [26]I think that in view of the pres-
ent distress it is good for a person to remain as he is. [27]Are you

bound to a wife? Do not seek to be free. Are you free from a
wife? Do not seek a wife. [28]But if you do marry, you have not
sinned, and if a betrothed woman marries, she has not sinned.
Yet those who marry will have worldly troubles, and I would
spare you that. [29]This is what I mean, brothers: the appointed
time has grown very short. From now on, let those who have
wives live as though they had none, [30]and those who mourn
as though they were not mourning, and those who rejoice as
though they were not rejoicing, and those who buy as though
they had no goods, [31]and those who deal with the world as
though they had no dealings with it. For the present form of
this world is passing away.

[32]I want you to be free from anxieties. The unmarried man
is anxious about the things of the Lord, how to please the
Lord. [33]But the married man is anxious about worldly things,
how to please his wife, [34]and his interests are divided. And the
unmarried or betrothed woman is anxious about the things
of the Lord, how to be holy in body and spirit. But the mar-
ried woman is anxious about worldly things, how to please
her husband. [35]I say this for your own benefit, not to lay any
restraint upon you, but to promote good order and to secure
your undivided devotion to the Lord.

[36]If anyone thinks that he is not behaving properly toward
his betrothed, if his passions are strong, and it has to be, let
him do as he wishes: let them marry—it is no sin. [37]But who-
ever is firmly established in his heart, being under no neces-
sity but having his desire under control, and has determined
this in his heart, to keep her as his betrothed, he will do well.

[38]So then he who marries his betrothed does well, and he who
refrains from marriage will do even better.

[39]A wife is bound to her husband as long as he lives. But
if her husband dies, she is free to be married to whom she
wishes, only in the Lord. [40]Yet in my judgment she is hap-
pier if she remains as she is. And I think that I too have the
Spirit of God.

8 Now concerning food offered to idols: we know that "all of
us possess knowledge." This "knowledge" puffs up, but love
builds up. [2]If anyone imagines that he knows something, he
does not yet know as he ought to know. [3]But if anyone loves
God, he is known by God.

[4]Therefore, as to the eating of food offered to idols, we
know that "an idol has no real existence," and that "there is
no God but one." [5]For although there may be so-called gods
in heaven or on earth—as indeed there are many "gods"
and many "lords"—[6]yet for us there is one God, the Father,
from whom are all things and for whom we exist, and one
Lord, Jesus Christ, through whom are all things and through
whom we exist.

[7]However, not all possess this knowledge. But some,
through former association with idols, eat food as really
offered to an idol, and their conscience, being weak, is defiled.
[8]Food will not commend us to God. We are no worse off if we
do not eat, and no better off if we do. [9]But take care that this
right of yours does not somehow become a stumbling block
to the weak. [10]For if anyone sees you who have knowledge
eating in an idol's temple, will he not be encouraged, if his

conscience is weak, to eat food offered to idols? [11]And so by
your knowledge this weak person is destroyed, the brother for
whom Christ died. [12]Thus, sinning against your brothers and
wounding their conscience when it is weak, you sin against
Christ. [13]Therefore, if food makes my brother stumble, I will
never eat meat, lest I make my brother stumble.

9 Am I not free? Am I not an apostle? Have I not seen Jesus
our Lord? Are not you my workmanship in the Lord? [2]If to
others I am not an apostle, at least I am to you, for you are the
seal of my apostleship in the Lord.

[3]This is my defense to those who would examine me. [4]Do
we not have the right to eat and drink? [5]Do we not have the
right to take along a believing wife, as do the other apos-
tles and the brothers of the Lord and Cephas? [6]Or is it only
Barnabas and I who have no right to refrain from working
for a living? [7]Who serves as a soldier at his own expense? Who
plants a vineyard without eating any of its fruit? Or who tends
a flock without getting some of the milk?

[8]Do I say these things on human authority? Does not the
Law say the same? [9]For it is written in the Law of Moses, "You
shall not muzzle an ox when it treads out the grain." Is it for
oxen that God is concerned? [10]Does he not certainly speak
for our sake? It was written for our sake, because the plow-
man should plow in hope and the thresher thresh in hope
of sharing in the crop. [11]If we have sown spiritual things
among you, is it too much if we reap material things from
you? [12]If others share this rightful claim on you, do not we
even more?

Nevertheless, we have not made use of this right, but we
endure anything rather than put an obstacle in the way of
the gospel of Christ. [13]Do you not know that those who are
employed in the temple service get their food from the tem-
ple, and those who serve at the altar share in the sacrificial
offerings? [14]In the same way, the Lord commanded that those
who proclaim the gospel should get their living by the gospel.

[15]But I have made no use of any of these rights, nor am I
writing these things to secure any such provision. For I would
rather die than have anyone deprive me of my ground for
boasting. [16]For if I preach the gospel, that gives me no ground
for boasting. For necessity is laid upon me. Woe to me if I do
not preach the gospel! [17]For if I do this of my own will, I have
a reward, but if not of my own will, I am still entrusted with a
stewardship. [18]What then is my reward? That in my preaching
I may present the gospel free of charge, so as not to make full
use of my right in the gospel.

[19]For though I am free from all, I have made myself a ser-
vant to all, that I might win more of them. [20]To the Jews I
became as a Jew, in order to win Jews. To those under the law I
became as one under the law (though not being myself under
the law) that I might win those under the law. [21]To those out-
side the law I became as one outside the law (not being out-
side the law of God but under the law of Christ) that I might
win those outside the law. [22]To the weak I became weak, that
I might win the weak. I have become all things to all people,
that by all means I might save some. [23]I do it all for the sake of
the gospel, that I may share with them in its blessings.

[24]Do you not know that in a race all the runners run, but
only one receives the prize? So run that you may obtain it.
[25]Every athlete exercises self-control in all things. They do it
to receive a perishable wreath, but we an imperishable. [26]So
I do not run aimlessly; I do not box as one beating the air.
[27]But I discipline my body and keep it under control, lest after
preaching to others I myself should be disqualified.

10 For I do not want you to be unaware, brothers, that our
fathers were all under the cloud, and all passed through the
sea, [2]and all were baptized into Moses in the cloud and in the
sea, [3]and all ate the same spiritual food, [4]and all drank the same
spiritual drink. For they drank from the spiritual Rock that
followed them, and the Rock was Christ. [5]Nevertheless, with
most of them God was not pleased, for they were overthrown
in the wilderness.

[6]Now these things took place as examples for us, that we
might not desire evil as they did. [7]Do not be idolaters as some
of them were; as it is written, "The people sat down to eat and
drink and rose up to play." [8]We must not indulge in sexual
immorality as some of them did, and twenty-three thousand
fell in a single day. [9]We must not put Christ to the test, as some
of them did and were destroyed by serpents, [10]nor grumble,
as some of them did and were destroyed by the Destroyer.
[11]Now these things happened to them as an example, but they
were written down for our instruction, on whom the end of
the ages has come. [12]Therefore let anyone who thinks that he
stands take heed lest he fall. [13]No temptation has overtaken
you that is not common to man. God is faithful, and he will

not let you be tempted beyond your ability, but with the
temptation he will also provide the way of escape, that you
may be able to endure it.

[14]Therefore, my beloved, flee from idolatry. [15]I speak as to
sensible people; judge for yourselves what I say. [16]The cup of
blessing that we bless, is it not a participation in the blood
of Christ? The bread that we break, is it not a participation
in the body of Christ? [17]Because there is one bread, we who
are many are one body, for we all partake of the one bread.
[18]Consider the people of Israel: are not those who eat the sac-
rifices participants in the altar? [19]What do I imply then? That
food offered to idols is anything, or that an idol is anything?
[20]No, I imply that what pagans sacrifice they offer to demons
and not to God. I do not want you to be participants with
demons. [21]You cannot drink the cup of the Lord and the cup
of demons. You cannot partake of the table of the Lord and
the table of demons. [22]Shall we provoke the Lord to jealousy?
Are we stronger than he?

[23]"All things are lawful," but not all things are helpful. "All
things are lawful," but not all things build up. [24]Let no one
seek his own good, but the good of his neighbor. [25]Eat what-
ever is sold in the meat market without raising any question
on the ground of conscience. [26]For "the earth is the Lord's,
and the fullness thereof." [27]If one of the unbelievers invites
you to dinner and you are disposed to go, eat whatever is
set before you without raising any question on the ground
of conscience. [28]But if someone says to you, "This has been
offered in sacrifice," then do not eat it, for the sake of the one

who informed you, and for the sake of conscience—[29]I do not
mean your conscience, but his. For why should my liberty be
determined by someone else's conscience? [30]If I partake with
thankfulness, why am I denounced because of that for which
I give thanks?

[31]So, whether you eat or drink, or whatever you do, do all
to the glory of God. [32]Give no offense to Jews or to Greeks or
to the church of God, [33]just as I try to please everyone in every-
thing I do, not seeking my own advantage, but that of many,
that they may be saved.

11 Be imitators of me, as I am of Christ.

[2]Now I commend you because you remember me in every-
thing and maintain the traditions even as I delivered them
to you. [3]But I want you to understand that the head of every
man is Christ, the head of a wife is her husband, and the head
of Christ is God. [4]Every man who prays or prophesies with
his head covered dishonors his head, [5]but every wife who
prays or prophesies with her head uncovered dishonors her
head, since it is the same as if her head were shaven. [6]For if
a wife will not cover her head, then she should cut her hair
short. But since it is disgraceful for a wife to cut off her hair
or shave her head, let her cover her head. [7]For a man ought
not to cover his head, since he is the image and glory of God,
but woman is the glory of man. [8]For man was not made from
woman, but woman from man. [9]Neither was man created for
woman, but woman for man. [10]That is why a wife ought to
have a symbol of authority on her head, because of the angels.
[11]Nevertheless, in the Lord woman is not independent of man

nor man of woman; [12]for as woman was made from man, so
man is now born of woman. And all things are from God.
[13]Judge for yourselves: is it proper for a wife to pray to God
with her head uncovered? [14]Does not nature itself teach you
that if a man wears long hair it is a disgrace for him, [15]but if a
woman has long hair, it is her glory? For her hair is given to
her for a covering. [16]If anyone is inclined to be contentious, we
have no such practice, nor do the churches of God.

[17]But in the following instructions I do not commend
you, because when you come together it is not for the better
but for the worse. [18]For, in the first place, when you come
together as a church, I hear that there are divisions among
you. And I believe it in part, [19]for there must be factions
among you in order that those who are genuine among you
may be recognized. [20]When you come together, it is not the
Lord's supper that you eat. [21]For in eating, each one goes
ahead with his own meal. One goes hungry, another gets
drunk. [22]What! Do you not have houses to eat and drink in?
Or do you despise the church of God and humiliate those
who have nothing? What shall I say to you? Shall I commend
you in this? No, I will not.

[23]For I received from the Lord what I also delivered to you,
that the Lord Jesus on the night when he was betrayed took
bread, [24]and when he had given thanks, he broke it, and said,
"This is my body, which is for you. Do this in remembrance
of me." [25]In the same way also he took the cup, after supper,
saying, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood. Do this, as
often as you drink it, in remembrance of me." [26]For as often as

you eat this bread and drink the cup, you proclaim the Lord's
death until he comes.

[27] Whoever, therefore, eats the bread or drinks the cup of
the Lord in an unworthy manner will be guilty concerning
the body and blood of the Lord. [28] Let a person examine him-
self, then, and so eat of the bread and drink of the cup. [29] For
anyone who eats and drinks without discerning the body
eats and drinks judgment on himself. [30] That is why many of
you are weak and ill, and some have died. [31] But if we judged
ourselves truly, we would not be judged. [32] But when we are
judged by the Lord, we are disciplined so that we may not be
condemned along with the world.

[33] So then, my brothers, when you come together to eat, wait
for one another — [34] if anyone is hungry, let him eat at home —
so that when you come together it will not be for judgment.
About the other things I will give directions when I come.

12 Now concerning spiritual gifts, brothers, I do not want
you to be uninformed. [2] You know that when you were pagans
you were led astray to mute idols, however you were led.
[3] Therefore I want you to understand that no one speaking in
the Spirit of God ever says "Jesus is accursed!" and no one can
say "Jesus is Lord" except in the Holy Spirit.

[4] Now there are varieties of gifts, but the same Spirit; [5] and
there are varieties of service, but the same Lord; [6] and there are
varieties of activities, but it is the same God who empowers
them all in everyone. [7] To each is given the manifestation of the
Spirit for the common good. [8] For to one is given through the
Spirit the utterance of wisdom, and to another the utterance

of knowledge according to the same Spirit, [9] to another faith
by the same Spirit, to another gifts of healing by the one Spirit,
[10] to another the working of miracles, to another prophecy, to
another the ability to distinguish between spirits, to another
various kinds of tongues, to another the interpretation of
tongues. [11] All these are empowered by one and the same Spirit,
who apportions to each one individually as he wills.

[12] For just as the body is one and has many members, and
all the members of the body, though many, are one body, so
it is with Christ. [13] For in one Spirit we were all baptized into
one body — Jews or Greeks, slaves or free — and all were made
to drink of one Spirit.

[14] For the body does not consist of one member but of
many. [15] If the foot should say, "Because I am not a hand, I do
not belong to the body," that would not make it any less a part
of the body. [16] And if the ear should say, "Because I am not an
eye, I do not belong to the body," that would not make it any
less a part of the body. [17] If the whole body were an eye, where
would be the sense of hearing? If the whole body were an ear,
where would be the sense of smell? [18] But as it is, God arranged
the members in the body, each one of them, as he chose. [19] If
all were a single member, where would the body be? [20] As it is,
there are many parts, yet one body.

[21] The eye cannot say to the hand, "I have no need of you,"
nor again the head to the feet, "I have no need of you." [22] On
the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker
are indispensable, [23] and on those parts of the body that we
think less honorable we bestow the greater honor, and our

unpresentable parts are treated with greater modesty, [24] which
our more presentable parts do not require. But God has so
composed the body, giving greater honor to the part that
lacked it, [25] that there may be no division in the body, but that
the members may have the same care for one another. [26] If one
member suffers, all suffer together; if one member is hon-
ored, all rejoice together.

[27] Now you are the body of Christ and individually mem-
bers of it. [28] And God has appointed in the church first apos-
tles, second prophets, third teachers, then miracles, then gifts
of healing, helping, administrating, and various kinds of
tongues. [29] Are all apostles? Are all prophets? Are all teachers?
Do all work miracles? [30] Do all possess gifts of healing? Do all
speak with tongues? Do all interpret? [31] But earnestly desire
the higher gifts.

And I will show you a still more excellent way.

13 If I speak in the tongues of men and of angels, but have
not love, I am a noisy gong or a clanging cymbal. [2] And if I
have prophetic powers, and understand all mysteries and
all knowledge, and if I have all faith, so as to remove moun-
tains, but have not love, I am nothing. [3] If I give away all I
have, and if I deliver up my body to be burned, but have not
love, I gain nothing.

[4] Love is patient and kind; love does not envy or boast; it is
not arrogant [5] or rude. It does not insist on its own way; it is
not irritable or resentful; [6] it does not rejoice at wrongdoing,
but rejoices with the truth. [7] Love bears all things, believes all
things, hopes all things, endures all things.

[8] Love never ends. As for prophecies, they will pass away;
as for tongues, they will cease; as for knowledge, it will pass
away. [9] For we know in part and we prophesy in part, [10] but
when the perfect comes, the partial will pass away. [11] When I
was a child, I spoke like a child, I thought like a child, I rea-
soned like a child. When I became a man, I gave up childish
ways. [12] For now we see in a mirror dimly, but then face to face.
Now I know in part; then I shall know fully, even as I have
been fully known.

[13] So now faith, hope, and love abide, these three; but the
greatest of these is love.

14 Pursue love, and earnestly desire the spiritual gifts, espe-
cially that you may prophesy. [2] For one who speaks in a tongue
speaks not to men but to God; for no one understands him,
but he utters mysteries in the Spirit. [3] On the other hand, the
one who prophesies speaks to people for their upbuilding
and encouragement and consolation. [4] The one who speaks
in a tongue builds up himself, but the one who prophesies
builds up the church. [5] Now I want you all to speak in tongues,
but even more to prophesy. The one who prophesies is greater
than the one who speaks in tongues, unless someone inter-
prets, so that the church may be built up.

[6] Now, brothers, if I come to you speaking in tongues,
how will I benefit you unless I bring you some revelation or
knowledge or prophecy or teaching? [7] If even lifeless instru-
ments, such as the flute or the harp, do not give distinct notes,
how will anyone know what is played? [8] And if the bugle gives
an indistinct sound, who will get ready for battle? [9] So with

yourselves, if with your tongue you utter speech that is not
intelligible, how will anyone know what is said? For you will
be speaking into the air. [10]There are doubtless many different
languages in the world, and none is without meaning, [11]but
if I do not know the meaning of the language, I will be a for-
eigner to the speaker and the speaker a foreigner to me. [12]So
with yourselves, since you are eager for manifestations of the
Spirit, strive to excel in building up the church.

[13]Therefore, one who speaks in a tongue should pray that
he may interpret. [14]For if I pray in a tongue, my spirit prays
but my mind is unfruitful. [15]What am I to do? I will pray with
my spirit, but I will pray with my mind also; I will sing praise
with my spirit, but I will sing with my mind also. [16]Otherwise,
if you give thanks with your spirit, how can anyone in the
position of an outsider say "Amen" to your thanksgiving
when he does not know what you are saying? [17]For you may be
giving thanks well enough, but the other person is not being
built up. [18]I thank God that I speak in tongues more than all of
you. [19]Nevertheless, in church I would rather speak five words
with my mind in order to instruct others, than ten thousand
words in a tongue.

[20]Brothers, do not be children in your thinking. Be infants
in evil, but in your thinking be mature. [21]In the Law it is writ-
ten, "By people of strange tongues and by the lips of foreign-
ers will I speak to this people, and even then they will not
listen to me, says the Lord." [22]Thus tongues are a sign not for
believers but for unbelievers, while prophecy is a sign not for
unbelievers but for believers. [23]If, therefore, the whole church

comes together and all speak in tongues, and outsiders or
unbelievers enter, will they not say that you are out of your
minds? [24]But if all prophesy, and an unbeliever or outsider
enters, he is convicted by all, he is called to account by all, [25]the
secrets of his heart are disclosed, and so, falling on his face, he
will worship God and declare that God is really among you.

[26]What then, brothers? When you come together, each one
has a hymn, a lesson, a revelation, a tongue, or an interpre-
tation. Let all things be done for building up. [27]If any speak
in a tongue, let there be only two or at most three, and each
in turn, and let someone interpret. [28]But if there is no one to
interpret, let each of them keep silent in church and speak
to himself and to God. [29]Let two or three prophets speak, and
let the others weigh what is said. [30]If a revelation is made to
another sitting there, let the first be silent. [31]For you can all
prophesy one by one, so that all may learn and all be encour-
aged, [32]and the spirits of prophets are subject to prophets.
[33]For God is not a God of confusion but of peace.

As in all the churches of the saints, [34]the women should
keep silent in the churches. For they are not permitted to speak,
but should be in submission, as the Law also says. [35]If there is
anything they desire to learn, let them ask their husbands at
home. For it is shameful for a woman to speak in church.

[36]Or was it from you that the word of God came? Or are
you the only ones it has reached? [37]If anyone thinks that he
is a prophet, or spiritual, he should acknowledge that the
things I am writing to you are a command of the Lord. [38]If
anyone does not recognize this, he is not recognized. [39]So,

my brothers, earnestly desire to prophesy, and do not forbid speaking in tongues. [40] But all things should be done decently and in order.

15 Now I would remind you, brothers, of the gospel I preached to you, which you received, in which you stand, [2] and by which you are being saved, if you hold fast to the word I preached to you—unless you believed in vain.

[3] For I delivered to you as of first importance what I also received: that Christ died for our sins in accordance with the Scriptures, [4] that he was buried, that he was raised on the third day in accordance with the Scriptures, [5] and that he appeared to Cephas, then to the twelve. [6] Then he appeared to more than five hundred brothers at one time, most of whom are still alive, though some have fallen asleep. [7] Then he appeared to James, then to all the apostles. [8] Last of all, as to one untimely born, he appeared also to me. [9] For I am the least of the apostles, unworthy to be called an apostle, because I persecuted the church of God. [10] But by the grace of God I am what I am, and his grace toward me was not in vain. On the contrary, I worked harder than any of them, though it was not I, but the grace of God that is with me. [11] Whether then it was I or they, so we preach and so you believed.

[12] Now if Christ is proclaimed as raised from the dead, how can some of you say that there is no resurrection of the dead? [13] But if there is no resurrection of the dead, then not even Christ has been raised. [14] And if Christ has not been raised, then our preaching is in vain and your faith is in vain. [15] We are even found to be misrepresenting God, because we testified

about God that he raised Christ, whom he did not raise if it is true that the dead are not raised. [16] For if the dead are not raised, not even Christ has been raised. [17] And if Christ has not been raised, your faith is futile and you are still in your sins. [18] Then those also who have fallen asleep in Christ have perished. [19] If in Christ we have hope in this life only, we are of all people most to be pitied.

[20] But in fact Christ has been raised from the dead, the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep. [21] For as by a man came death, by a man has come also the resurrection of the dead. [22] For as in Adam all die, so also in Christ shall all be made alive. [23] But each in his own order: Christ the firstfruits, then at his coming those who belong to Christ. [24] Then comes the end, when he delivers the kingdom to God the Father after destroying every rule and every authority and power. [25] For he must reign until he has put all his enemies under his feet. [26] The last enemy to be destroyed is death. [27] For "God has put all things in subjection under his feet." But when it says, "all things are put in subjection," it is plain that he is excepted who put all things in subjection under him. [28] When all things are subjected to him, then the Son himself will also be subjected to him who put all things in subjection under him, that God may be all in all.

[29] Otherwise, what do people mean by being baptized on behalf of the dead? If the dead are not raised at all, why are people baptized on their behalf? [30] Why are we in danger every hour? [31] I protest, brothers, by my pride in you, which I have in Christ Jesus our Lord, I die every day! [32] What do I gain if,

humanly speaking, I fought with beasts at Ephesus? If the
dead are not raised, "Let us eat and drink, for tomorrow we
die." [33] Do not be deceived: "Bad company ruins good morals."
[34] Wake up from your drunken stupor, as is right, and do not
go on sinning. For some have no knowledge of God. I say this
to your shame.

[35] But someone will ask, "How are the dead raised? With
what kind of body do they come?" [36] You foolish person! What
you sow does not come to life unless it dies. [37] And what you
sow is not the body that is to be, but a bare kernel, perhaps of
wheat or of some other grain. [38] But God gives it a body as he
has chosen, and to each kind of seed its own body. [39] For not all
flesh is the same, but there is one kind for humans, another
for animals, another for birds, and another for fish. [40] There
are heavenly bodies and earthly bodies, but the glory of the
heavenly is of one kind, and the glory of the earthly is of
another. [41] There is one glory of the sun, and another glory of
the moon, and another glory of the stars; for star differs from
star in glory.

[42] So is it with the resurrection of the dead. What is sown is
perishable; what is raised is imperishable. [43] It is sown in dis-
honor; it is raised in glory. It is sown in weakness; it is raised in
power. [44] It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body.
If there is a natural body, there is also a spiritual body. [45] Thus
it is written, "The first man Adam became a living being"; the
last Adam became a life-giving spirit. [46] But it is not the spiri-
tual that is first but the natural, and then the spiritual. [47] The
first man was from the earth, a man of dust; the second man

is from heaven. [48] As was the man of dust, so also are those who
are of the dust, and as is the man of heaven, so also are those
who are of heaven. [49] Just as we have borne the image of the
man of dust, we shall also bear the image of the man of heaven.

[50] I tell you this, brothers: flesh and blood cannot inherit the
kingdom of God, nor does the perishable inherit the imper-
ishable. [51] Behold! I tell you a mystery. We shall not all sleep,
but we shall all be changed, [52] in a moment, in the twinkling
of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound, and
the dead will be raised imperishable, and we shall be changed.
[53] For this perishable body must put on the imperishable,
and this mortal body must put on immortality. [54] When the
perishable puts on the imperishable, and the mortal puts on
immortality, then shall come to pass the saying that is written:

"Death is swallowed up in victory."
[55] "O death, where is your victory?
O death, where is your sting?"

[56] The sting of death is sin, and the power of sin is the law. [57] But
thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord
Jesus Christ.

[58] Therefore, my beloved brothers, be steadfast, immov-
able, always abounding in the work of the Lord, knowing that
in the Lord your labor is not in vain.

16 Now concerning the collection for the saints: as I directed
the churches of Galatia, so you also are to do. [2] On the first day
of every week, each of you is to put something aside and store
it up, as he may prosper, so that there will be no collecting

when I come. [3]And when I arrive, I will send those whom you
accredit by letter to carry your gift to Jerusalem. [4]If it seems
advisable that I should go also, they will accompany me.

[5]I will visit you after passing through Macedonia, for I
intend to pass through Macedonia, [6]and perhaps I will stay
with you or even spend the winter, so that you may help me
on my journey, wherever I go. [7]For I do not want to see you
now just in passing. I hope to spend some time with you, if
the Lord permits. [8]But I will stay in Ephesus until Pentecost,
[9]for a wide door for effective work has opened to me, and there
are many adversaries.

[10]When Timothy comes, see that you put him at ease
among you, for he is doing the work of the Lord, as I am. [11]So
let no one despise him. Help him on his way in peace, that he
may return to me, for I am expecting him with the brothers.

[12]Now concerning our brother Apollos, I strongly urged
him to visit you with the other brothers, but it was not at all
his will to come now. He will come when he has opportunity.

[13]Be watchful, stand firm in the faith, act like men, be
strong. [14]Let all that you do be done in love.

[15]Now I urge you, brothers—you know that the house-
hold of Stephanas were the first converts in Achaia, and that
they have devoted themselves to the service of the saints—[16]be
subject to such as these, and to every fellow worker and
laborer. [17]I rejoice at the coming of Stephanas and Fortunatus
and Achaicus, because they have made up for your absence,
[18]for they refreshed my spirit as well as yours. Give recognition
to such people.

[19]The churches of Asia send you greetings. Aquila and
Prisca, together with the church in their house, send you
hearty greetings in the Lord. [20]All the brothers send you greet-
ings. Greet one another with a holy kiss.

[21]I, Paul, write this greeting with my own hand. [22]If anyone
has no love for the Lord, let him be accursed. Our Lord, come!
[23]The grace of the Lord Jesus be with you. [24]My love be with
you all in Christ Jesus. Amen.